



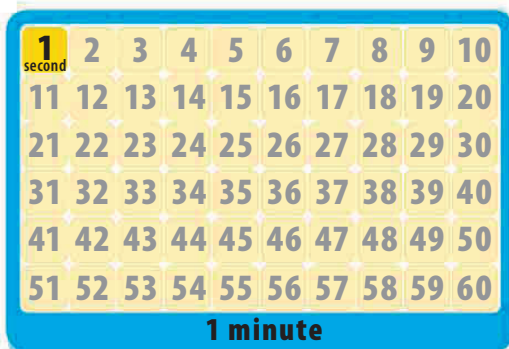
Telling the time

TIME IS MEASURED IN THE SAME WAY AROUND THE WORLD.
THE MAIN UNITS ARE SECONDS, MINUTES, AND HOURS.

Telling the time is an important skill and one that is used in many ways: What time is breakfast? How long until my birthday? Which is the quickest route?

Measuring time

Units of time measure how long events take and the gaps between the events. Sometimes it is important to measure time exactly, in a science experiment for example. At other times, accuracy of measurement is not so important, such as when we go to a friend's house to play. For thousands of years time was measured simply by observing the movement of the sun, moon, or stars, but now our watches and clocks are extremely accurate.

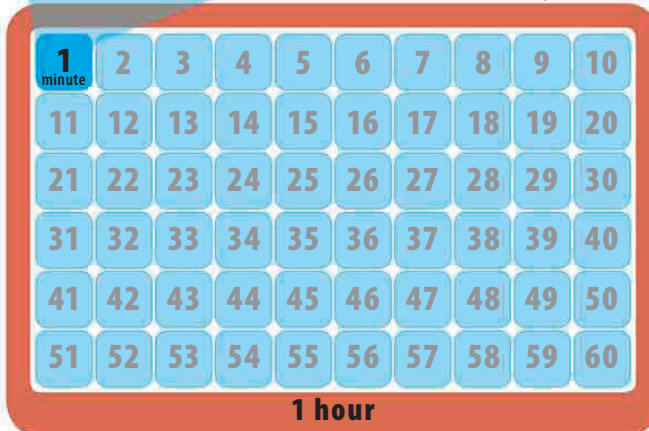


Units of time

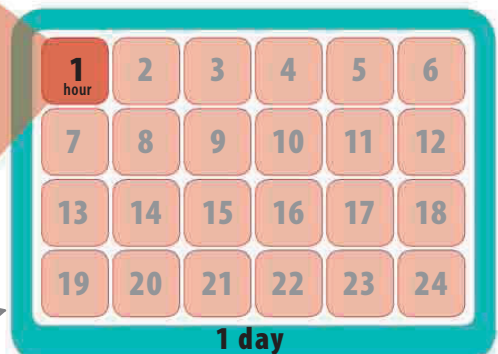
The units we use around the world are based on 1 second as measured by International Atomic Time. There are 86,400 seconds in one day.

There are 60 seconds in each minute.

There are 60 minutes in each hour.



There are 24 hours in each day.



SEE ALSO

◀ 14–15 Introducing numbers

◀ 28–29 Units of measurement

Bigger units of time

This is a list of the most commonly used bigger units of time. Other units include the Olympiad, which is a period of 4 years and starts on January 1st of a year in which the summer Olympics take place.

7 days is 1 week

Fortnight is short for 14 nights and is the same as 2 weeks

Between 28 and 31 days is 1 month

365 days is 1 year (366 in a leap year)

10 years is a decade

100 years is a century

1000 years is a millennium